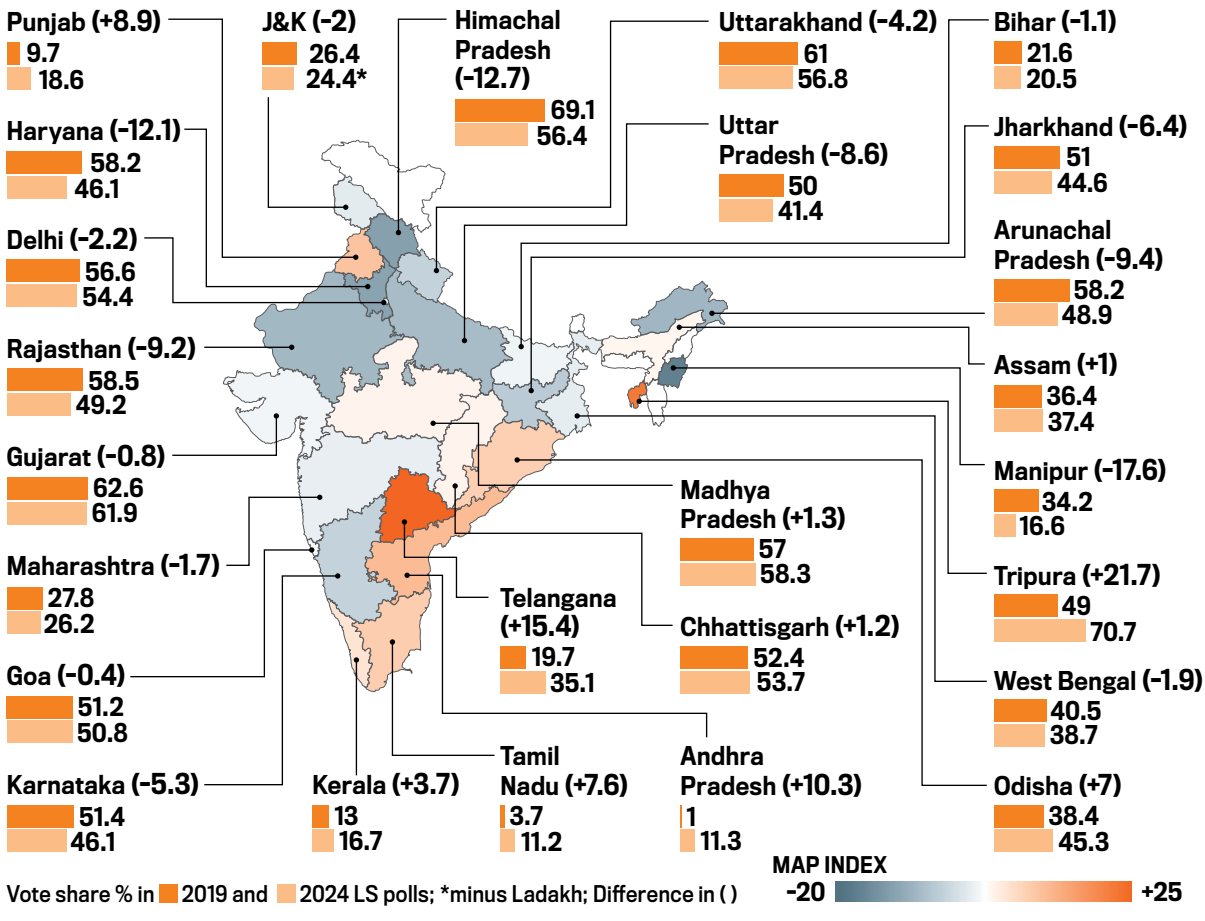
SHIFTING WINDS

State-wise change in the BJP's vote-share percentage in 2024 over 2019



stake in the Union government as well as more central funds for their respective states, accommodative politics and governance will be the need of the hour.

Pushy allies are already demanding a major stake in the Union government and more funds for their states...necessitating accommodative politics and governance

INTERNAL POSTMORTEM

In the past decade, the BJP had developed a reputation as a relentless election machine—always whirring, never tiring, drawing and redrawing its templates like a giant self-learning algorithm as it chewed up the scenery. This time, the computer shows signs of needing a reboot. Among the error messages the cadre had tried to flash was the policy of wholesale duty-free 'imports' and then the investing of trust and position on them over old loyalists. This frequently led to unfortunate candidate picks. In a private conversation, a top BJP leader cites Rahul Kaswan, two-term MP from Churu, Rajasthan—his long intergenerational family association with the BJP was overlooked as the leadership denied him a ticket. Kaswan switched over to the Congress and won Churu by 72,737 votes. State-wise lists were replete with such arbitrary selections that left old-timers feeling disoriented and unwanted. The preference for turncoats, even to form state governments, deepened the demotivation. In the past decade, the BJP has changed all its chief ministers, even replacing some with political lightweights. Rajasthan's Bhajan Lal Sharma is a classic case in point—the BJP leadership sidelined several top leaders, including popular two-time CM